

Slides 4.6: Elements of Design in a Real Room

Slide outline for Lesson 4.6. Fourteen slides, one day. Slides 3 to 10 are the element cards; they come back as the review before the Design Vocabulary Check. *[Sal: the described photos should be replaced by photos of real rooms, and the classroom slide by a photo of your room.]*

Slide 1: Elements of Design

- Lesson 4.6
- Today: the eight things every room is made of, and how to see them
- Then: you move them Image: a plain living room photo with no labels yet.

Slide 2: Do now

- Look around this room. Write three words for what you see.
- Not objects. Not “desk” or “sink.”
- Words like straight, round, rough, bright, crowded, empty
- Two minutes Notes: Cold call six students, one word each. Group them on the board as you write: straight goes to line, round to shape, rough to texture, bright to light, crowded to space. They just named five elements.

Slide 3: Line

- The direction your eye follows
- Vertical: tall, formal. Horizontal: calm, wide. Diagonal: active. Curved: soft.
- Where in this room? The cabinet doors, the table edges, the clock Image: a room where tall bookshelves, a low couch, and a curved lamp are each outlined in a different color. Notes: Under the title, the word in Turkish (çizgi), Portuguese (linha), Spanish (línea). Same for every element slide.

Slide 4: Shape

- A flat outline: round, square, triangle
- Shape is the drawing Image: the same room with the round table top, the rectangular window, and the circles in a painting outlined.

Slide 5: Form

- The 3D thing you can walk around
- Form is the object
- Hold up a piece of paper (shape) and a mug (form) Image: a chair photographed from three angles. Notes: This is the pair students confuse. Say “shape is the drawing, form is the thing” and hold up the paper and the mug.

Slide 6: Space

- The room itself, and what fills it

- Positive space: where the things are. Negative space: where they are not.
- Empty is not wasted. Empty is breathing room. Image: two versions of the same room, one packed to the walls, one with an open corner.

Slide 7: Color

- Warm (red, orange, yellow) or cool (blue, green, purple)
- Light or dark
- Full lesson on Wednesday with frosting. Today, just notice it. Image: two identical rooms, one painted warm, one cool.

Slide 8: Texture

- How a surface feels, or looks like it feels
- Rough or smooth, soft or hard, shiny or matte
- Touch what you are allowed to touch Image: close-ups of a wool blanket, a brick wall, a glass table, a velvet pillow.

Slide 9: Pattern

- A design that repeats
- Stripes, checks, diamonds, florals, tiles
- One pattern is a choice. Five patterns is a fight. Image: a rug with a diamond pattern next to striped curtains.

Slide 10: Light

- Natural: windows, doors, skylights
- Artificial: ceiling fixtures, lamps
- Light changes every other element. The same room is a different room at noon and at night. Image: the same room photographed in daylight and at night with one lamp on.

Slide 11: Hunt A, the described living room

- Read it twice on the handout
- Long and narrow; two tall windows; a pale warm gray wall; a dark blue nubby couch; a round shiny table; a diamond rug; a packed bookshelf; a curved lamp; an empty corner; a bare white brick wall; orange circles over the couch
- Find all eight. Write what each one does to the feel. Image: a drawing of that room, matching the description. Notes: Teams of three. Five minutes here, five on Hunt B.

Slide 12: Hunt B, this room

- Stand up. Find all eight in here.
- "The ___ makes the room feel ___"
- Five minutes Image: a photo of the classroom. Notes: Circulate with the clipboard. The question is always: and what does that do to the room?

Slide 13: Rearrange the room

- A bed under the window; a desk facing the wall in the dark corner; a rug in the middle; a tall bookshelf beside the door; everything pushed to one side
- Redraw it so at least three elements change
- One line per change: what changed and why it is better
- Or draw your own bedroom (no address, no names) Image: a rough top-down sketch of that bedroom. Notes: Nine minutes. Keep the sketches; they are the first draft for the project in Lesson 4.11.

Slide 14: Exit card

- 3 elements you can find in your own room tonight
- 2 elements you changed in your sketch
- 1 element you are still not sure about
- Hand vote: which one element changes a room the most? Notes: Light and space usually win. Read three line-3 answers and answer each in one sentence.